The Rails Command Line

1 Command Line Basics

There are a few commands that are absolutely critical to your everyday usage of Rails. In the order of how much you'll probably use them are:

- `rails console`
- `rails server`
- `rake`
- `rails generate`
- `rails dbconsole`
- `rails new app_name`

All commands can run with `-h` or `--help` to list more information.
Let's create a simple Rails application to step through each of these commands in context.

1.1 `rails new`

The first thing we'll want to do is create a new Rails application by running the `rails new` command after installing Rails.
You can install the rails gem by typing `gem install rails`, if you don't have it already.

```
$ rails new commandsapp
     create
     create  README.rdoc
     create  Rakefile
     create  config.ru
     create  .gitignore
     create  Gemfile
     create  app
     ...
     create  tmp/cache
     ...
        run  bundle install
```

Rails will set you up with what seems like a huge amount of stuff for such a tiny command! You've got the entire Rails directory structure now with all the code you need to run our simple application right out of the box.

1.2 `rails server`

The `rails server` command launches a small web server named WEBrick which comes bundled with Ruby. You'll use this any time you want to access your application through a web browser.
With no further work, `rails server` will run our new shiny Rails app:

```
$ cd commandsapp
$ bin/rails server
=> Booting WEBrick
=> Rails 5.0.0 application starting in development on
http://localhost:3000
=> Call with -d to detach
=> Ctrl-C to shutdown server
[2013-08-07 02:00:01] INFO  WEBrick 1.3.1
[2013-08-07 02:00:01] INFO  ruby 2.0.0 (2013-06-27) [x86_64-
darwin11.2.0]
```